# Inner Garden Field Guide

## Gut Microbiome Ecology, SCFA Signaling & Mucosal Barrier Integrity

The gut is a living microbial rainforest where short-chain fatty acids (butyrate, acetate, propionate) communicate with the vagus nerve and regulate systemic immune signaling.

## Core Biophysics Principles

**1. Mucosal Lining Integrity**
Tight junction proteins (zonulin, occludin) protect systemic circulation from endotoxins like Lipopolysaccharide (LPS).

**2. Short-Chain Fatty Acid (SCFA) Cascades**
Microbial fermentation of fermentable fibers feeds colonocytes and regulates inflammatory gene expression.

**3. Microbiome Circadian Rhythmicity**
Gut microbes follow daily light/dark oscillations that coordinate metabolic rate and neurotransmitter synthesis.

## Key Protocol Elements & Interventions

- Spore-Based & Human-Origin Microbiota Strains
- Mucosal Barrier Repair (L-Glutamine, Zinc Carnosine, Deglycyrrhizinated Licorice)
- Prebiotic Diversity Blend (Acacia Fiber, Inulin, Polyphenols)
- Targeted Botanical Antimicrobials & SCFA Boosters

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